REPORT ON PUTTING EJB JOURNAL ON THE INTERNET

Reference and purpose

During the last Executive Committee meeting of June 200-, it was requested to investigate the feasibility of turning EJB (European Journal of Biology) into an electronic journal available on the Internet.

Investigation and methods

1. As documented by the Directory of Electronic Journals, a great number (33%) of scholarly journals and newsletters all over the world have become electronic in the past decade.

2. A questionnaire was sent to 150 scholars all over Europe with a view to having indications about academic attitudes towards electronic publishing.

3. Journals that are already on line were contacted to gather information about implementation and operation procedures.

Findings or results.

1. The 122 people who returned the completed questionnaire reported that electronic journals offered numerous advantages such as immediate access, lower costs, faster dissemination of knowledge and easier contact between scholars.

2. Concern was however expressed about the assurance of quality (are the publications peer-reviewed?), the protection of copyright and the availability of revenues to pay the service provider for the upkeep of the site and of the archives.

3. Some respondents argued that copyright was a false issue since academics do not expect revenue from their publications and since quality through peer-review could be maintained.

Financial implications

Becoming electronic generates enormous savings in printing, storage and distribution costs which, in the case of EJB, amount to 50,000 euros per year.

The initial expenses involved in putting the journal on the Web are estimated at 60,000 euros for the first year followed by an annual upkeep,cost of 15,000 euros. This low operation cost is due to the fact that we are a society and, as such, rely heavily on voluntary work.

Conclusions and recommendations

It is clear that becoming electronic is the ideal solution for EJB since the objective of the Society is the non-commercial dissemination and advancement of scientific knowledge. The Internet would offer the additional possibility of publishing an electronic newsletter and of setting up an interactive forum of ideas between our members.
Though the long-term savings also support this option, financing remains a crucial issue. The Committee will have to decide about the source of funds, which could come from subsidies, from access fees paid by subscribers or from a pay-per-view system of access to the archives.

Professor Brown December 200-

PIGIER COTE D'IVOIRE
ABIDJAN

17 février 2012
EXERCICES

MATIERE	RÉFÉRENCES			PROFESSEUR
A	19	MASTER	2012	Dr KONE
Thème :				Durée :

THE BUSINESS ACTIVITY REPORT

A formal business report consists of three possible types: informational, analytical or recommendation reports. Regardless of the objective that you need to accomplish, the basic format of every formal business report is the same. Planning and writing a proper business report that reaches its intended audience and motivates its readers take planning, research and a commitment to the success of the report.

Instructions

1- Write out your front matter. The front matter of the report consists of the cover, title page, abstract, table of contents, list of illustrations and executive summary..The abstract is a short technical summary of the document that usually contains no more than 200 words.

The **executive summary** presents the background of the report and major findings and implications to managers. It should include a summary of all of the key points, the idea is that an **executive** can read the summary and if it appears logical and in line with expectations, the recommendations can be followed without the need to read further. This is in fact the most important part of the report and should be written last. The executive summary should include a summary of all parts of the report including recommendations. (if you are sending the report via email, include the executive summary in the main part of your email, so that a busy executive doesn't have to read an attachment to read the main points.)

2- Write the introduction for your report. The introduction helps the audience understand the technical discussion that is going to follow. It should say why the report is being written. Reports are nearly always written to solve a business problem. Reports maybe **commissioned** because there is a crisis or they may be routine. Nearly all reports in some way answer the age-old business problem, how can we increase profits? It is often written first, but maybe **refined** at anytime. It is useful to write the reference and purpose of the report. Who commissioned the financial activity or report?

3- Write the methods used for your report. The methods answer the question of what was done for the report. Supply enough information here so the audience understands what you did and why did it this way.

4- Write the results section for your report. This is the data that you've discovered or compiled after finishing your methods. Present results objectively without comment. Sometimes reports don't say Findings, but it is normally assumed that the main part of your report will be the information you have found. This information is not always read by executives, but that doesn't mean it isn't important, because without **thorough** research and analysis the author will not be able to come to effective conclusions and create recommendations. Also if anything in the executive summary surprises the executive, then they will turn directly to the relevant part of the recommendations. This part is normally written after the first **draft** of the introduction.

5- Write the conclusion. The conclusion section is the implication (s) of the results. The conclusions tell the audience what the methods and results all mean. They should summarize the findings section, do not include diagrams or graphs in this area. This area should be short, clearly follow the order of the findings and lead naturally into the recommendations. You should not include new information in the conclusions. It is written after the findings.
6- Write the recommendations section for your report. This section consists of suggestions of particular actions to take. It tells the readers what they should do after reading the conclusions. All reports should include recommendations or at least suggestions. It is important to make sure that there is at least an indicator of what the **Return** on Investment would be. It is always best if this can be directly linked, but may not always be possible. Make sure that your recommendations clearly follow what is said in the conclusions. They come after the conclusions.
7- Compose the **back matter**, which consists of any or all of the following items: glossary, list of symbols, references and appendices.

Task one: Skimming. *List the main elements of a business activity report.*

Task two: scanning 1

A- Match the words or expressions from column A with their French translations in B.

A-	*B-*
1-an activity report	a-engagement
2-a commitment	b-gestionnaire supérieur, cadre, directeur, chef de service
3- (executive) summary	c-attentes, espérances
4- executive	d-rapport d'activité(s)
5- an expectation	e-résumé, synthèse (de rapport)
	f- le pouvoir exécutif

B- Find in the text words or expressions which correspond to the following meanings :

1- Something done completely and with great attention to details, not superficial.
2- Rough preliminary written version (of a report) draft
3- Order somebody or give him/her the job of making something (a task for ex.) commission
4- To improve (a report) by removing defects, errors from it. refine
5- Elements written on the last page of a written document (a report) which indicate useful technical items, symbols … back matter.

Task three: Scanning 2.

Say whether the following sentences are true or false according to the content of the text.

1- The executive summary is the first element of the report to be written.
2- The introduction of the report states the reasons for writing it.
3- Recommendations appear in the last position of the report.
4- The conclusion should contain diagrams, graphs and all new information.
5- The findings or results of the report should be clearly laid out, objectively presented.
6- Recommendations are a compulsory component of any report.

Task 4: Read the text and answer the following questions.

1- To what extent is the introduction of a report important?
2- What are the main differences between the front matter and the back matter of the report?
3- Why can we say that the executive summary is the most important part of the report?
4- How can you account for the presence of recommendations after the conclusion?

Task 5: Writing

Design a report for an activity you have conducted. It could be a group homework in class, a business activity, … The recommendations and steps suggested in the text may help.

Task six: Translate the following sentences either into English or into French.

1- Ce rapport a été écrit à la demande du comité de pilotage.
2- Le présent chapitre du rapport contient un résumé de chacune de ces affaires.
3- Deux membres enverront par écrit des propositions précises de formulation au directeur exécutif.
4- Une évaluation externe commandée par la BEI (Banque européenne d'investissement) aboutit également à la conclusion que la durabilité des projets constituait un point essentiel.
5- By shareholders' request/ Commissioned by shareholders, an annual activity report shall be produced and submitted to the commission within three months from the end of the financial year.
6- ARCOS Annual Report 2008 highlights major achievements during the year 2008 including the recommendations of the successful Second Regional Forum and the consultative Mid - Term Review of ARCOS Strategy 2006-2010.
7- Reference and purpose: During the last Executive Committee meeting of June 2011, it was requested to investigate the feasibility of turning EJB (European Journal of Biology) into an electronic journal on the Internet.